

**North Dakota State University
Wind Symphony
Spring 2026**

Class Information

Wind Symphony (MUSC 303, 1 credit) or Graduate Ensemble (MUSC 709, 1 credit)

Class meets MWF: 12:15-1:50*, Band Room (Challey Hall)

*On sectional days, rehearsal may start at 12:00, but will only last an hour

Instructor Information

Dr. Daniel Lee

Daniel.Lee.3@ndsu.edu (please email directly, not through Blackboard)

Office Hours: M/W 10:00-11:00, Challey Hall 227

Course Description

Training of the musician in a broad spectrum of musical styles, forms, and repertoire. May be repeated. *Prerequisite: Placement in ensemble by audition.*

Course Objectives

Performance of music at a high level of competency; musical independence; the development of a limited technical vocabulary to describe music.

Student Resources

No textbook is required for this course. Sheet music will be provided by the CSoM Band Library. Students are expected to attend each class with a complete instrument, all sheet music, and pencils for marking parts.

Activities, Requirements, Assignments

- A. Prepare all music for the highest quality of artistic performance possible, the majority of which will occur *outside of the rehearsal*.
- B. Participate in all rehearsals, special rehearsals and performances.
- C. Concert dress (required of all students) is black: i.e., Black tuxedo with long black tie and black shirt, appropriate black pantsuit, black long dress, etc. Full arms should be covered, and garments should cover full legs. Black shoes and socks/stockings.
- D. *Professionalism*. One of the main goals of these performing ensembles is to provide a sense of the responsibility necessary to participate in a professional organization. Each student is expected to exhibit a professional attitude in behavior, work, preparation, and performance.

Evaluation Procedures and Criteria

Student participation in band is predicated on a good faith expectation of the student's preparation in every aspect. This includes such factors as: adequate private practice and preparation, participation in sectional rehearsals, participation in large ensemble rehearsals, and regular, sustained musical growth. A student's base grade is directly related to all aspects of participation (including attendance) and will be assessed accordingly.

Attendance Statement

According to [NDSU Policy 333](#), attendance in classes is expected.

Travel: This course may require travel to competition and performance events off-campus or out-of-town, including overnight events.

Veterans and student service members with special circumstances or who are activated are encouraged to notify the instructor as soon as possible and are encouraged to provide Activation Orders.

This course is graded solely on attendance; please review the Grading Policy below.

Academic Honesty Statement

The academic community is operated on the basis of honesty, integrity, and fair play. [NDSU Policy 335: Code of Academic Responsibility and Conduct](#) applies to cases in which cheating, plagiarism, or other academic misconduct have occurred in an instructional context. Students found guilty of academic misconduct are subject to penalties, up to and possibly including suspension and/or expulsion. Student academic misconduct records are maintained by the [Office of the Provost](#). Informational resources about academic honesty for students and instructional staff members can be found at www.ndsu.edu/academichonesty.

Americans with Disabilities Act Statement

Any students with disabilities who need special accommodations in this course are invited to share these concerns or requests with the instructor and contact the [Center for Accessibility and Disability Resources](#) as soon as possible.

Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA) Statement

Your personally identifiable information and educational records as they relate to this course are subject to [FERPA](#).

Grading Policy

- The course grade is based on attendance. Students who are unprepared or underperforming in the course will be asked to put more attention on their practice/ensemble work, may be placed on lower parts, and/or may be placed in other ensembles in future semesters. However, the course grade will be solely based on attendance.
- Please communicate issues regarding attendance with me as soon as possible.
- Absences: Due to the nature of a music ensemble, it is impossible to make up rehearsals and performances. One individual's absence from rehearsal and/or performance can and often does have a profound effect on the whole ensemble, potentially rendering some rehearsals and performances impractical or impossible. Therefore, three (3) absences will be permitted for any reason. Students should plan personal business such as routine medical appointments, family trips/gatherings/celebrations, etc. with these absences in mind. After the 3rd absence, grades will be lowered by one letter grade; more than 6 absences will result in a grade of "F" for the semester.
- Tardies: Three tardies will be counted as one absence.
- Students missing a performance for **any** reason other than those defined in [NDSU Policy 333](#) section 4 as "excused absences" will receive a grade of "F" for the semester.
- Travel, including overnight travel, may occur as a part of this course. Attendance during required travel events is not optional and fall under the same category as any other performance.

Grading Scale

A – 3 or fewer absences from class

B – 4 absences from class

C – 5 absences from class

D – 6 absences from class

F – More than 6 absences from class, or any unexcused absence from a performance

Final Exam

The Final Exam time for this course is May 12, 2026, at 10:30am. Please hold this time available for Wind Symphony, but you will be notified if the final exam time is not needed for this course.

Rehearsals/Sectionals

- All rehearsals (including additional rehearsals such as evening rehearsals) are required. Students will be notified in an adequate amount of time regarding additional rehearsals; it is the student's responsibility to make necessary arrangements.
- Sectional rehearsal times may be determined within each section. Section leaders have the right and authority to increase the number of sectionals should the need for the increase be evident.
- It is unfair to the rest of the members in your section to rely on the sectional as your "opportunity" to practice your part. Prepare adequately through private practice and do not be the reason for additional sectionals—that is both inappropriate and unprofessional.

Course Communication

Official course communication may happen through email, announcements on Blackboard, announcements through messaging apps (like Slack), and/or verbally during class. Please ensure that you review communications regularly, including checking with Dr. Lee or another bandmember for announcements made during a missed rehearsal.

Course Schedule

Rehearsals are held weekly on MWF from 12:15-1:50 p.m., occasionally starting at 12:00n for sectional days. A rehearsal schedule for each week will be posted before the start of that week. Important event dates for Spring 2026 are listed below.

- Friday/Saturday, 2/20-2/21, ND Intercollegiate Band at Bismarck State College (overnight trip, for selected students)
- Friday, 2/27, Extra Wind Symphony Rehearsal with Kevin Day and Boston Brass (sometime between 5:00-9:00, TBD)
- Saturday, 2/28, Wind Symphony Concert with Kevin Day and Boston Brass, 7:30pm (call time earlier)
- Tuesday/Wednesday, 3/3-3/4, Raging Red Festival Performance, 11:45am both days
 - Everyone will be required to work hours for this event, more information to come
- Saturday, 5/2, Wind Symphony Concert, 7:30pm (call time earlier)